



## AFTER

In the aftermath of his defeat at Second Bull Run, Pope retreated to the outer defenses of Washington. Recriminations began immediately as a scapegoat was sought.

### McCLELLAN'S OBSTRUCTION



McCLELLAN PASSING THROUGH FREDERICK CITY

President Lincoln believed that **McClellan was the most culpable**: having wanted Pope to fail, McClellan had **intentionally delayed his troops** from coming to his rival's aid.

### POPE'S ILL FORTUNE

Lincoln also reluctantly accepted that McClellan was the best man to take over the **defense of Washington** when morale was at its lowest. While Pope was **relegated to fighting Indians** in Minnesota, McClellan was allowed to integrate the Army of Virginia into his Army of the Potomac. His appointment was greeted with **relief and enthusiasm** by soldiers and civilians alike.